flow from childhood stories to health to even impromptu songs.

Service providers also rely on their clients to form interest-based social and support groups, which help them bond and foster a sense of togetherness. The Bollywood Club is the most popular social group at Emoha, says Rashmi Gautam. She has performed 13 times at their cultural programmes and excitedly claims, "I'm called the Bollywood queen of Emoha."

In addition to these services, there are start-ups offering niche services. The Ratan Tata-backed Goodfellows, for instance, hires young people to offer companionship to the elderly as a service. WisdomCircle helps seniors above the age of 50 find jobs and feel relevant in their golden years.

Travelling Light

Having dispensed with their responsibilities, the elderly are now finding the time and the money to spend on themselves. And travel is a crucial part of this liberation, as Gen S pursues their passions with a vengeance and has no qualms about giving in to their wanderlust. Varanasi-based Prem Narain Pandey, 74, a former sales and marketing professional, has gone on seven trips with his wife Madhu through Silverwings senior group holidays. "We are free now and want to see the world as long as our health allows," he says.

Why senior-only groups? The relaxed pace, a preference for quiet places and the expectation of customised cuisine to suit their dietary preferences. A Frost & Sullivan report projects that the number of elderly travellers in India is expected to grow seven-fold to 7.3 million by 2030. The increase in travel is also on account of seniors visiting their children who have migrated away from their hometowns.

"Travel is the biggest discretionary spending that elders make," says Shefali Jain Mishra, founder of KareVoyage, which provides holiday packages for the elderly. Their queries have



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR



To help seniors rediscover hobbies and socialise, many service providers help organise events, learning programmes and social gatherings to participate in

increased by over 30 per cent over the last two years post-Covid, thanks to the pent-up demand. Mahindra Holidays & Resorts India also launched Bliss, a membership product for senior citizens, back in 2017.

In fact, seniors love adventure within their physical limitations. If not bungee-jumping, hot air ballooning or a ride on a speed boat certainly, says Mishra. "The sense of adventure doesn't change with age; in fact, you feel you want to do it before it's too late," says 73-year-old Naveen Anand, promoter of the New Delhi-based sound and vibration instrumentation firm Baseline Technologies, who takes three to four such trips a year. "Rolling up my pants and wading through the cold water of a river in Arunachal is just as exciting today as it was earlier," he says.

Nor is it small and local destinations that seniors are restricting